

THE SLOW ATLAS



Thailand

Road Trip Atlas

The complete guide & planner – legendary routes, slowly travelled.

4 ROUTES • ITINERARIES • PHRASEBOOK • FOOD • PLANNING PAGES

A SLOW ATLAS GUIDE • VOLUME I

What's inside



This is a road-tripper's companion to Thailand — written for travellers who'd rather wind through mountain villages and roadside noodle stalls than rush between airports. It is two books in one: a practical guide to doing Thailand well, and a planner to make the trip your own.

THE GUIDE

- Thailand in brief
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- Staying safe & healthy
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- A Thai phrasebook
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THE ROUTES & PLANNER

- The four great routes
- Mae Hong Son Loop (7 days)
- The Andaman Coast
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- Responsible travel
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— FILLABLE —

- Bucket list · Trip overview
- Budget · Itinerary grid
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- Journal & notes

Thailand in brief

THE LAND

Thailand sits at the heart of mainland South-East Asia — roughly the size of France, and shaped a little like an elephant's head. From the cool, folded mountains of the north it stretches 1,650 km south down a slender peninsula of jungle and islands between two seas: the Gulf of Thailand to the east, the Andaman to the west.

A QUICK HISTORY

The kingdom of Siam was never colonised — a point of deep national pride. The Thai monarchy is revered (and protected by law), Theravada Buddhism shapes daily life, and the result is a culture that is at once relaxed and quietly formal.

WHY DRIVE IT

- Freedom to reach villages, viewpoints and waterfalls the buses skip.
- Roads are good, fuel is cheap, and the scenery is the attraction.
- You set the pace — the essence of slow travel.

THE ESSENTIALS

Capital	Bangkok (Krung Thep)
Population	≈71 million
Language	Thai (English widely used in tourism)
Religion	Theravada Buddhism (≈93%)
Currency	Thai baht (THB)
Drives on	The LEFT
Plugs	Type A / B / C · 230V
Time zone	GMT +7 (no daylight saving)
Calling code	+66
Best months	November – February

FIVE QUICK WINS

- Carry cash in small notes.
- Learn 'sawatdee' and 'khop khun'.
- Always agree taxi/tuk-tuk prices first.
- Dress modestly at temples.
- Smile — it's the national language.

The four regions · I

02

The North

CHIANG MAI · CHIANG RAI · PAI · MAE HONG SON

Cool mountains, hill-tribe cultures, ornate Lanna temples and the country's best road trips. Slower, greener and gentler than the south — and the spiritual home of this atlas. Don't miss: khao soi, the Mae Hong Son Loop, and the Yi Peng lantern festival.

- Cooler climate, especially Nov–Feb
- Lanna culture & Burmese influence
- Trekking, waterfalls, coffee country

The Centre

BANGKOK · AYUTTHAYA · KANCHANABURI · HUA HIN

The flat, fertile rice bowl and the beating heart of the kingdom. Frenetic Bangkok, the romantic ruins of old Ayutthaya, the River Kwai, and easy weekend escapes. The gateway most journeys begin from.

- Thailand's transport hub
- Ancient capitals & royal history
- Floating markets & big-city energy

The four regions · II

02

Isaan (North-East)

KHORAT · PHIMAI · UBON · NONG KHAI · THE MEKONG

The vast plateau few visitors see — and all the richer for it. Khmer temples older than Angkor, silk-weaving villages, the mighty Mekong, fiery food and the warmest welcome in Thailand. Wonderfully cheap and gloriously authentic.

- Khmer ruins & Lao-influenced culture
- Som tam, larb & sticky rice
- Big skies, slow villages

The South

PHUKET · KRABI · KHAO SOK · KOH LANTA · THE ISLANDS

Postcard Thailand: limestone karsts rising from turquoise seas, rainforest national parks, and beaches for every mood. Two coasts mean there's almost always somewhere dry — when one side rains, cross to the other.

- Andaman & Gulf coasts
- Diving, kayaking, island-hopping
- Richer, spicier southern curries

SLOW ATLAS TIP

Don't try to 'do' all four regions in one trip. Pick one or two and travel them slowly — Thailand rewards depth far more than distance.

When to go & festivals

Choosing the right window matters more in Thailand than almost anywhere. There are three broad seasons — and the north and south often run on different clocks.

Cool & dry NOV – FEB	The sweet spot: comfortable days, clear skies, cool hill evenings. Peak season — book ahead.
Hot MAR – MAY	Fierce heat; Mar–Apr brings haze to the north. Songkran (mid-Apr) is a joyous water-fight new year.
Green & wet JUN – OCT	Warm monsoon — short, heavy afternoon bursts. Lush, quiet and cheap. The south's Andaman side is wettest.

A MONTH-BY-MONTH ALMANAC

MONTH	WEATHER	DON'T MISS	MONTH	WEATHER	DON'T MISS
Jan	Cool, dry, perfect	Peak season	Jul	Monsoon	Asalha Puja / Buddhist Lent
Feb	Warm, dry	Chiang Mai Flower Fest.	Aug	Wettest in places	Quiet, lush
Mar	Hot, northern haze	—	Sep	Heavy rains	Lowest prices
Apr	Hottest month	Songkran (water new year)	Oct	Rains ease	Vegetarian Festival
May	Hot, first rains	Low season begins	Nov	Cool & dry returns	Loy Krathong / Yi Peng
Jun	Warm, wet spells	Green & cheap	Dec	Cool, dry, busy	High season

Visas, money & costs

ENTRY & VISAS

- Many nationalities (incl. EU, UK, US, Australia) enter visa-free for short stays — the exact length changes, so confirm the current rule before you fly.
- Your passport must be valid 6+ months beyond arrival.
- You may be asked for proof of onward travel and funds.
- Overstaying carries a daily fine — don't risk it.

MONEY BASICS

- The baht (THB) is cash-first outside cities — carry small notes.
- ATMs are everywhere but charge ≈THB 220 per foreign withdrawal; take larger amounts, less often.
- Cards work in malls, hotels and chains; markets and stalls are cash only.
- Tell your bank you're travelling; carry a backup card.

WHAT IT COSTS (PER DAY, PER PERSON)

STYLE	APPROX / DAY	LOOKS LIKE
Backpacker	THB 900–1,500	Hostels, street food, scooters
Comfort	THB 2,500–4,500	Nice guesthouses,
Boutique	THB 6,000+	Design hotels, some nights, drivers, spas

ROUGH PRICES TO ANCHOR ON

- Street meal: THB 50–80
- Local beer: THB 70–100
- Scooter hire: THB 200–300/day
- Litre of petrol: ≈THB 40
- Guesthouse double: THB 600–1,200
- Long-distance train: THB 200–900

TIPPING

Not expected, but rounding up or leaving THB 20–50 is a kind gesture.

Driving in Thailand

THE NON-NEGOTIABLES

- Carry an International Driving Permit (IDP) plus your home licence — police checkpoints are common and your insurance depends on it.
- Drive on the LEFT. The unwritten rule is 'give way to bigger' — buses and trucks rule.
- Helmets are mandatory on scooters (and life-saving). Wear closed shoes.
- Avoid night driving: unlit vehicles, animals and potholes.

CHECKPOINTS & POLICE

- Routine stops are normal — be calm and polite, show IDP + licence.
- Small on-the-spot fines for minor infractions happen; ask for a receipt.
- Keep digital and paper copies of your documents.

ROADS & NAVIGATION

- Highways are good; mountain roads are narrow and twisty but paved.
- Fuel stations (PTT, Bangchak) are frequent — but fill up before remote stretches.
- Download offline maps (Google offline or Maps.me); signal drops in the hills.
- Petrol stops often have clean toilets, Café Amazon coffee and a 7-Eleven.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Stay at the scene; call 1669 (ambulance) or 191 (police) if needed.
- Photograph everything for insurance before moving vehicles.
- Tourist Police (English): 1155.
- Your travel insurance must explicitly cover motorbikes.

Confidence on two wheels? The north is bliss. Not sure? Hire a small car — air-con is a gift in the heat.

Renting a scooter or car

SCOOTER / MOTORBIKE

The classic way to ride the northern loops — cheap (≈THB 200–300/day) and freeing. For mountains, choose a 150cc+ (semi-) automatic; a 125cc struggles on steep grades two-up.

BEFORE YOU RIDE OFF — CHECK

- Brakes, tyres, lights and horn all work.
- Photograph every existing scratch with the owner.
- A helmet that actually fits (bring your own if fussy).
- Never hand over your passport as deposit — pay cash instead.
- Fuel level — return it as you got it.

CAR HIRE

Safer for families and the rainy season. From ≈THB 900–1,400/day. International desks (Avis, Budget, local firms) sit at every major airport. Book ahead in high season.

INSURANCE — READ THIS

- Take the fullest cover offered; understand the excess.
- Photograph the car all round before leaving the lot.
- Your home/credit-card insurance rarely covers Thailand — check.
- For scooters, most travel policies need a valid motorcycle licence + IDP to pay out.

APPS THAT HELP

- Grab — taxis & food when you'd rather not drive.
- Google Maps (download offline regions).
- Bolt — ride-hailing in big cities.

Staying safe & healthy

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HEALTH

- Tap water isn't drinkable — buy big bottles or carry a filter. Ice in cafés is generally fine.
- Eat where locals queue and food is cooked fresh and hot.
- Pack rehydration salts, plasters, antiseptic, anti-diarrhoeals and your own meds.
- Mosquito repellent (DEET) dusk & dawn; consider it for dengue, not just comfort.
- Check vaccination advice with a travel clinic 6–8 weeks ahead.

EMERGENCY NUMBERS

- Police 191 · Ambulance 1669
- Tourist Police (English) 1155
- Tourist info (TAT) 1672

COMMON SCAMS — SMILE & DECLINE

- 'The temple/palace is closed today' — it isn't; the tout has a gem shop to show you.
- Tuk-tuk 'tours' for almost nothing — they detour to commission stops.
- Rigged taxi meters — insist on the meter or agree a price first.
- Jet-ski / scooter 'damage' claims — photograph everything at pickup.
- Over-friendly strangers with card games or 'free' drinks.

SENSIBLE & SAFE

- Thailand is generally very safe; petty theft is the main risk.
- Use hotel safes; keep a card and some cash separate.
- Women travel widely and easily — usual night-time common sense applies.
- Respect the sea: heed red flags and rip-current warnings.

Connectivity & apps

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GETTING ONLINE

- Buy a tourist SIM (AIS, TrueMove, dtac) at the airport, or load an eSIM before you fly.
- Data is fast, generous and cheap (tourist packs from ≈THB 200).
- 4G/5G coverage is excellent — except deep in the mountains, hence offline maps.
- Most cafés and guesthouses have free Wi-Fi.

APPS WORTH INSTALLING

Grab — rides + food delivery

Google Maps — with offline regions saved

Google Translate — Thai pack + camera mode

Bolt — ride-hailing in cities

XE / a currency app — quick baht conversions

Klook — tickets & day tours

12Go — trains, buses, ferries

LINE — how Thais message

Culture & etiquette

DO

- Return a 'wai' (palms together) with a smile.
- Dress modestly at temples — shoulders and knees covered.
- Remove shoes before entering homes and temples.
- Keep calm; a smile defuses almost anything.
- Use your right hand (or both) to give and receive.

DON'T

- Touch anyone's head — even a child's.
- Point your feet at people or Buddha images.
- Raise your voice or show anger ('losing face').
- Disrespect the monarchy — it's against the law.
- Step over food or people sitting on the floor.

AT THE TEMPLE (WAT)

- Cover up, remove shoes and hat, lower your voice.
- Women should not touch monks or hand things directly to them.
- Sit with feet tucked behind you, not pointing at the Buddha.
- A small donation for upkeep is welcome.

GOOD TO UNDERSTAND

'Sanuk' (fun) and 'jai yen' (a cool heart) are guiding ideas: Thais value good humour and composure. 'Mai pen rai' — never mind, it's fine — is a whole philosophy. Match the easy warmth you're shown and doors open everywhere.

A Thai phrasebook

ESSENTIALS

Hello — sawatdee (khrap/kha)**Thank you** — khop khun (khrap/kha)**Yes / No** — chai / mai chai**Please** — karuna**Sorry / excuse me** — khor thot**You're welcome** — mai pen rai**Do you speak English?** — phut angkrit dai mai?**I don't understand** — mai khao jai

GETTING AROUND

Where is...? — ...yu thi nai?**How much?** — tao rai?**Too expensive** — phaeng pai**Turn left / right** — liao sai / liao khwa**Stop here** — jort thi ni**Petrol station** — pam nam man

NUMBERS

1 nung · 2 song · 3 sam · 4 si · 5 ha · 6 hok · 7 jet · 8
paet · 9 kao · 10 sip · 20 yi-sip · 100 nung roi · 1,000
nung phan

AT THE TABLE

Delicious! — aroi!**Not spicy, please** — mai phet**A little spicy** — phet nit noi**Vegetarian** — mangsawirat / jay**No fish sauce** — mai sai nam pla**The bill, please** — check bin**Water** — nam plao**Cheers!** — chon kaew!

EMERGENCIES

Help! — chuay duay!**Hospital** — rong phayaban**Police** — tamruat**I'm lost** — chan long thang

Men end sentences politely with 'khrap', women with 'kha'. Thai is tonal — say it with a smile and you'll be understood.

Eating in Thailand



HOW STREET FOOD WORKS

- The best meals come from carts and tiny shophouses — follow the crowds of locals.
- Many stalls cook one dish brilliantly; point if you can't pronounce it.
- Sit, eat, pay after. A bowl of noodles is THB 50–80.
- Markets cluster at dawn and dusk — go hungry.

SPICE & HOW TO ORDER

- 'Mai phet' = not spicy; 'phet nit noi' = a little. Thai 'a little' is still a lot.
- Condiments on the table: fish sauce, chilli, sugar, vinegar — season to taste.
- Rice ('khao') is the centre of every meal.

VEGETARIAN & ALLERGIES

- 'Mangsawirat' = vegetarian; 'jay' = strict vegan (no garlic/onion), look for the yellow-red '๒๒' flag.
- Fish sauce and shrimp paste hide everywhere — say 'mai sai nam pla / mai sai kapi'.
- Peanuts are common; carry a translation card for serious allergies.

DRINKS TO TRY

- Cha yen — sweet orange iced tea.
- Nam manao — fresh lime soda.
- Fresh fruit shakes (ask 'mai sai nam tan' for no sugar).
- Singha, Chang & Leo — the local beers, served very cold.
- Roadside coffee — Café Amazon is everywhere.

Turn the page for a region-by-region glossary of what to order.

A glossary of dishes



THE NORTH

Khao soi — the crowning dish — egg noodles in a coconut-curry broth, crisp noodles on top

Sai ua — herby grilled Chiang Mai sausage

Nam prik num — smoky green-chilli dip with sticky rice & veg

Gaeng hang lay — rich Burmese-style pork curry

Khanom jeen — fermented rice noodles with curry

CENTRAL & BANGKOK

Pad krapow — holy-basil stir-fry with a fried egg — the nation's comfort food

Tom yum goong — hot-and-sour prawn soup

Pad thai — the famous wok noodles

Khao man gai — Hainanese chicken & rice

Massaman — mild, fragrant curry of Persian roots

ISAAN (NORTH-EAST)

Som tam — pounded green-papaya salad — order 'nit noi phet'!

Larb — zingy minced-meat salad with herbs & toasted rice

Gai yang — marinated grilled chicken

Sai krok Isan — sour fermented pork sausage

Khao niao — sticky rice — eaten by hand with everything

THE SOUTH & SWEETS

Gaeng tai pla — intense southern fish-curry — for the brave

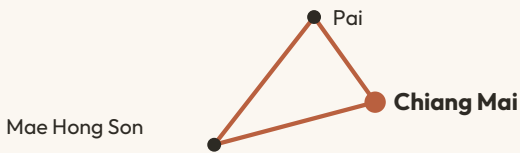
Khao yam — herbal rice salad

Massaman / seafood — coconut-rich curries, fresh from the sea

Mango sticky rice — khao niao mamuang — the dessert

Roti — griddled banana-and-egg pancake, street-side

The four great routes



ROUTE	DAYS	BEST FOR
1 · Mae Hong Son Loop	5-7	Mountains, villages, the classic ride
2 · Andaman Coast	5-8	Beaches, karsts, island-hopping
3 · Isaan & Mekong	6-9	Khmer ruins, food, the road less travelled
4 · Bangkok-Kanchanaburi	3-4	Waterfalls, history, an easy first trip

PICK YOUR PACE

Short on time? Combine route 4 with a few Bangkok days. Two weeks? The Mae Hong Son Loop plus the north. A month? Link the north to the islands by an internal flight and drive both ends.



Schematic — not to scale

ROUTE 1

The Mae Hong Son Loop

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Thailand's most loved drive traces a great circle through the north-western mountains from Chiang Mai — famous for its 1,864 marked curves (there's a sticker to prove you survived them).

But the joy is in going slowly: dawn mist pooling in the valleys, roadside coffee, waterfalls, hot springs, and Shan-culture towns that feel a world away from Bangkok.

AT A GLANCE

Distance	≈600 km
Duration	5–7 days (we suggest 7)
Start / end	Chiang Mai Mae Hong Son
Direction	Anti-clockwise (Pai first)
Vehicle	Scooter 150cc+ or small car
Season	Nov – Feb
Don't miss	Tham Lod cave, Doi Inthanon



The Mae Hong Son Loop

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DAY 1

Chiang Mai – Pai

📏 135 km • 3–4 h

Ease in with the famous climb to Pai — 762 curves of forest and viewpoints. Stop at Mok Fa waterfall and the roadside coffee stands. Arrive by mid-afternoon for Pai's slow, bohemian rhythm.

Eat — Pai Walking Street night market.

Stay — Pai — riverside bungalows or a hillside guesthouse.

DAY 2

Around Pai

Rest day

Park the bike. Catch dawn at Pai Canyon, soak in the Tha Pai hot springs, see the Land Split and the white Wat Phra That Mae Yen for sunset over the valley.

Eat — A long, lazy café breakfast.

Stay — A second night in Pai.

DAY 3

Pai – Mae Hong Son

📏 110 km • 3 h

The quietest, prettiest leg. Detour to Tham Lod cave (by bamboo raft and lantern) and the Su Tong Pae bamboo bridge. Mae Hong Son is a calm, Shan-flavoured town ringed by mountains.

Eat — Lakeside stalls by Nong Jong Kham at dusk.

Stay — Mae Hong Son, near the lake.

The Mae Hong Son Loop

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DAY 4**Mae Hong Son – Khun Yuam – Mae Sariang**

📏 160 km • 4 h

Climb to Ban Rak Thai, a Yunnanese tea village near the Myanmar border, for breakfast among the hills. Roll south via Khun Yuam's poignant WWII museum to sleepy, riverside Mae Sariang.

Eat — Thai-Shan cooking in Mae Sariang.

Stay — Mae Sariang, by the Yuam river.

DAY 5**Mae Sariang – Mae Chaem**

📏 170 km • 4–5 h

A remote, beautiful stretch — fuel up first. The road winds through forest and rice terraces to Mae Chaem, a traditional weaving town few travellers reach. Quiet nights, big stars.

Eat — Simple local kitchens — point and smile.

Stay — Mae Chaem — homestay or guesthouse.

LOOP WISDOM

- Ride defensively — locals overtake on blind bends; hug the left.
- Fuel and cash are scarce between towns; top up in Mae Hong Son and Mae Sariang.
- Mornings are clearest for mountain views; afternoons can cloud over.

The Mae Hong Son Loop

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DAY 6

Mae Chaem – Doi Inthanon – Chiang Mai

📏 150 km · 4 h

Climb to the roof of Thailand (2,565 m): the twin royal pagodas, cloud forest and the Pha Dok Siew waterfall trail. Then descend the eastern side back toward Chiang Mai.

Eat — Karen-grown coffee on the mountain.

Stay — Chiang Mai's old city.

DAY 7

Chiang Mai

Slow finish

Reward the ride: a Thai massage, a cooking class, and the old-city temples and Sunday Walking Street. Toast 1,864 curves survived. Chon kaew!

Eat — One last bowl of khao soi.

Stay — Chiang Mai.

The Andaman Coast



Limestone karsts, rainforest and beaches for every mood, strung down Thailand's west coast. Best November to April. Fly into Phuket, drive south, and finish island-slow on Koh Lanta.

THE DRIVE, DAY BY DAY

D1-2 **Phuket & Phang Nga Bay**

Old-town shophouses, then a long-tail through James Bond Island's sea-stacks and hidden lagoons.

D3-4 **Khao Sok National Park**

Jungle older than the Amazon; kayak the emerald Cheow Lan lake and sleep in a floating raft-house.

D5-6 **Krabi, Ao Nang & Railay**

Climbers' karsts, beach bars and a boat to cliff-ringed Railay (reachable only by sea).

D7-8 **Koh Lanta**

Wind down on long, quiet west-coast beaches and the old Lanta town for sunset seafood.



Isaan & the Mekong



The Thailand few visitors see: Khmer temples older than Angkor, silk villages, fiery food and the great Mekong. Authentic, warm and gloriously cheap. Loop north-east from Bangkok or Khao Yai.

THE DRIVE, DAY BY DAY

D1-2 **Khao Yai**

Thailand's oldest national park — waterfalls, gibbons, vineyards and elephants in the wild.

D3 **Phimai**

A magnificent Khmer temple that pre-dates and inspired Angkor Wat.

D4 **Phanom Rung**

A sandstone sanctuary on an extinct volcano, aligned to the rising sun.

D5-6 **Ubon & Khong Chiam**

River life where the Mekong meets the Mun, and the 'two-coloured river'.

D7-8 **Up the Mekong to Nong Khai**

Riverside sunsets, the surreal Sala Keoku sculpture park, and the road home.



ROUTE 4

Bangkok – Kanchanaburi



Waterfalls, wartime history and floating markets – the easiest first road trip from the capital, and a beautiful long weekend.

THE DRIVE, DAY BY DAY

D1 Bangkok to Kanchanaburi

Stop at the giant chedi of Nakhon Pathom; reach the River Kwai by afternoon.

D2 River Kwai & the Death Railway

The bridge, the moving war museum and cemeteries, and a ride on the cliff-hugging railway.

D3 Erawan National Park

Climb past seven tiers of turquoise pools – swim in the cool, clear water.

D4 Sangkhlaburi (optional)

Thailand's longest wooden bridge, a Mon community, and misty lake mornings.



Responsible travel

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ANIMALS

- Don't ride elephants or visit shows. Choose genuine sanctuaries where elephants roam and are never ridden — research before you book.
- Avoid tiger selfies and any 'photo with a drugged animal'.
- Don't feed wild monkeys; secure your food and shiny things.

COMMUNITIES

- Buy from local markets, family kitchens and village artisans.
- Ask before photographing people, especially hill-tribe elders.
- Learn a few Thai words — it's met with real warmth.
- Hire local guides; spread your spending beyond the resorts.

THE PLANET

- Refill a bottle — plastic waste is a real problem here.
- Reef-safe sunscreen when you snorkel or dive.
- Never touch or stand on coral; keep your distance from marine life.
- Take tuk-tuks and songthaews; combine errands to cut trips.
- Carry out your litter on remote roads and trails.

AT TEMPLES & SACRED SITES

- Dress and behave modestly; never climb on ruins or Buddha images.
- A small donation keeps these places alive.
- Quiet, please — they are places of worship, not just photos.

The slow traveller's creed: take only photos, leave only footprints, and spend where it stays local.

Inspiration & reading

READ BEFORE YOU GO

Sightseeing — Rattawut Lapcharoensap — luminous Thai short stories

Bangkok 8 — John Burdett — atmospheric crime thriller

The Beach — Alex Garland — the backpacker myth, for better or worse

Very Thai — Philip Cornwel-Smith — the brilliant book of everyday culture

Fieldwork — Mischa Berlinski — the hills of the north

WATCH

Uncle Boonmee... — Apichatpong's dreamlike Palme d'Or winner

Only God Forgives — neon-soaked Bangkok noir

Chef's Table / street-food docs — for the appetite

A GLOSSARY OF TERMS

wat — temple

soi — side-street / lane

songthaew — shared pick-up taxi

tuk-tuk — three-wheeled taxi

khao — rice / hill

nam — water / river

doi — mountain (northern)

talat — market

farang — foreigner (not rude)

mai pen rai — never mind, it's fine

sanuk — fun — a core value

jai yen — a cool, calm heart

Thailand bucket list

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Tick off the experiences as you go.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Survive all 1,864 curves of the Mae Hong Son Loop | ☐ Watch dawn mist fill the valley near Pai |
| ☐ Soak in a natural hot spring after a ride | ☐ Slurp khao soi in Chiang Mai |
| ☐ Stand on Thailand's roof at Doi Inthanon | ☐ Release a lantern at Yi Peng / Loy Krathong |
| ☐ Share sticky rice with a hill-tribe family | ☐ Ride a long-tail through Andaman karsts |
| ☐ Take a Thai cooking class | ☐ Give alms to monks at sunrise |
| ☐ Temple-hop the ruins of Ayutthaya | ☐ Find an empty beach with no name |
| ☐ Kayak the jungle lake at Khao Sok | ☐ Eat at a night market until you can't move |
| ☐ Cross the Mon bridge at Sangkhlaburi | ☐ Learn to say 'aroi!' and mean it |

Trip overview

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TRIP NAME

TRAVELLERS

ARRIVE

DEPART

NIGHTS

REGIONS / ROUTES

TOTAL BUDGET

FLIGHTS IN / OUT

VEHICLE

MUST-DO EXPERIENCES

NOTES

Trip budget

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CATEGORY	PLANNED	ACTUAL
Flights		
Vehicle rental		
Fuel		
Accommodation		
Food & drink		
Activities & tours		
Entry / visa		
SIM & extras		
Shopping		
Buffer		
TOTAL		

Itinerary at a glance

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A bird's-eye view of your whole trip – one line per day.

DAY	DATE	FROM - TO	SLEEP	NOTES
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

Stays & reservations

PLACE / TOWN	ACCOMMODATION	DATES	CONFIRMATION #

Packing for Thailand

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RIDING & SAFETY

- ☐ Helmet (or hire a good one)
- ☐ Light gloves
- ☐ Sunglasses
- ☐ Rain poncho
- ☐ Closed shoes

TROPICAL KIT

- ☐ High-SPF, reef-safe sunscreen
- ☐ Insect repellent (DEET)
- ☐ Reusable water bottle
- ☐ Quick-dry clothes
- ☐ Sarong / scarf
- ☐ Flip-flops

HEALTH

- ☐ Travel insurance docs
- ☐ Rehydration salts
- ☐ Basic first-aid kit
- ☐ Anti-diarrhoeals
- ☐ Hand sanitiser
- ☐ Personal meds

DOCUMENTS & TECH

- ☐ IDP + driving licence
- ☐ Passport + copies
- ☐ Offline maps saved
- ☐ Power bank
- ☐ Universal adapter
- ☐ Spare card + cash

Daily plan

17

Copy or reprint for each day on the road.

DAY / DATE

ROUTE — FROM / TO

DISTANCE

DRIVING TIME

OVERNIGHT

STOPS & SIGHTS ALONG THE WAY

WHERE TO EAT

NOTES & MEMORIES

Travel journal

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DATE

WHERE / MOOD

TODAY'S STORY

"The journey itself is the reward."

BEST BITE

DISCOVERY

Notes



Chok dee

Good luck, and enjoy every curve.

THE SLOW ATLAS · RENNES, FRANCE